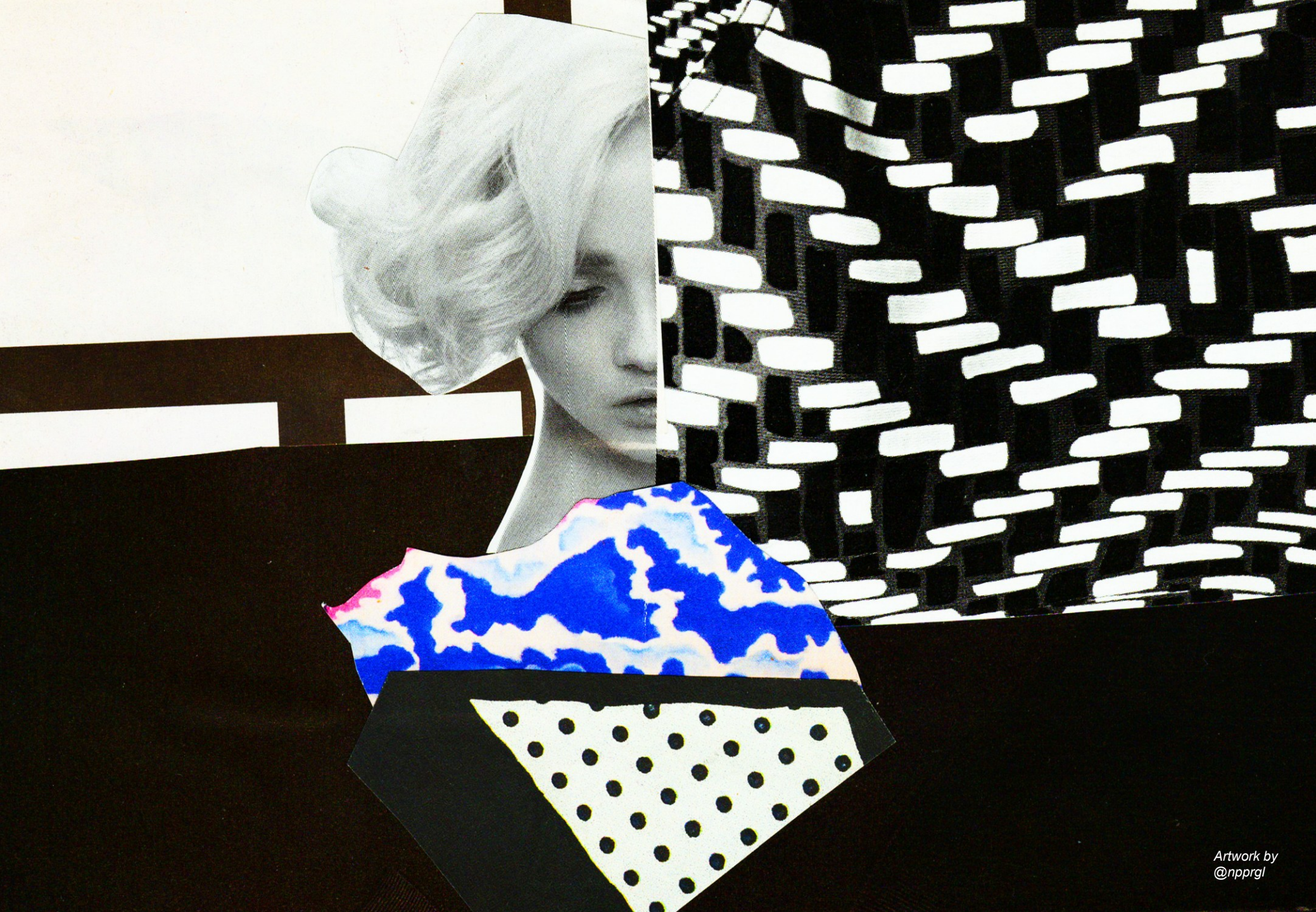




info.nodes

Man in the loop

show of force

Davide Del Monte
www.infonodes.org

Artwork by
[@npprgl](https://twitter.com/npprgl)

0. Who we are

info.nodes is an Italian nonprofit organization, founded in 2019 by journalists and activists to experiment new solutions in the Italian civil society and media landscape.

We focus on **social and climate justice**, the **impact of new technologies on human rights**, and the **protection of freedom of speech**.

We produce investigations, connect tech-activists, researchers, and artists, develop innovative advocacy and communication formats to reach wider audiences.

We also organize exhibitions, networking events, offer technical training for journalists and activists, and create investigative-based comms materials.

We love to work in collaboration with other organizations, because **“no man is an island”**.

Project team: Davide Del Monte, Laura Carrer, Andrea Daniele Signorelli

In collaboration with:

Datapitch

An Italian company providing support in data analysis and data visualization, thanks to their experience in database development and management, multimedia content production, and the creation of digital tools.

TBD

We are still looking for an editorial partner.

We need to obtain some preliminary results, in order to decide which type of publication can ensure the maximum impact: a series of articles, a single investigation, an academic-style research, a book?

1. Objective and scope

Identifying who truly holds the reins of autonomous weapons research and production, by reconstructing decision-making influence and investments across the entire supply chain.

Companies

Tech: $\approx$ 15.000 billion of USD

Defence: $\approx$ 1.000 billion of USD

Mining: $\approx$ 900 billion of USD

Investment Funds

BlackRock, Vanguard Group, Fidelity Investments, State Street Global Advisors, JP Morgan

Venture Capital

Andreessen Horowitz (a16z), Sequoia Capital, Tiger Global Management, New Enterprise Associates (NEA), Lightspeed Venture Partners

Our ideal goal:

Identify the main investors and governance relationships in:

Tech / Defence / Mining



2. The 3 main focus

1.

Start-up in Europe

We want to highlight the significant growth of the **European startup sector** dedicated to the development of autonomous systems and defense technologies.

Helsing	Germany
ARX Robotics	Germany
Quantum Systems	Germany
Destinus	Netherlands
Tekever	Portugal
Comand AI	France
Intelic (nome legale Avalor AI)	Netherlands
Arondite	United Kingdom
Origin Robotics	Latvia
Roark Aerospace	United Kingdom
Unmanned Defence Systems	Lithuania
Alpine Eagle	Germany
Alta Ares	France
C2Grid	Estonia
Delian	United Kingdom
ICEYE	Finland
Nordic Air Defence	Sweden
XRF	Spain

2.

Private investors in MoT

As mentioned, one of the pieces of information we are most interested in is which funds, other companies, or individuals are investing in the sector. Ideally, we would be able to determine if certain **entities are investing across multiple segments of the supply chain, thereby securing a position of not just economic advantage, but of decision-making power.**

If an entity is present at every stage of the chain (raw material extraction → development of AI-based technologies → production of armaments using such technology), it is evident that their power increases considerably.

3.

Public EU funding to MoT

Regarding the startup sector in particular, we also want to understand the **role played by European institutions**, specifically in financially backing and thus promoting the development of this industrial sector.

At this stage, we are mapping the various European funds and programs directing capital toward this area.

Starting from April, we plan to collect all data on funding, projects, and beneficiaries from the various European portals.

3. Methodology in brief

1.

Identification of companies

Ongoing (test completed)

A first test list of companies was created in February.

We will add a new wave of companies and other subjects (April / June).

2.

Data collection

Ongoing

We are now collecting all the information about investors.

In a next phase we will try to collect information about governance and or relationships with public universities.

3.

Data Analysis

Testing phase

We are already «playing» with data, in order to better understand what we can extract from them.

Any advice is welcome here!

4.

Research / Investigation

Final phase

Once we have collected all the information and processed all the data, we will go in-depth with companies or cases that seem particularly interesting.

4. The research

1.

Identification of companies

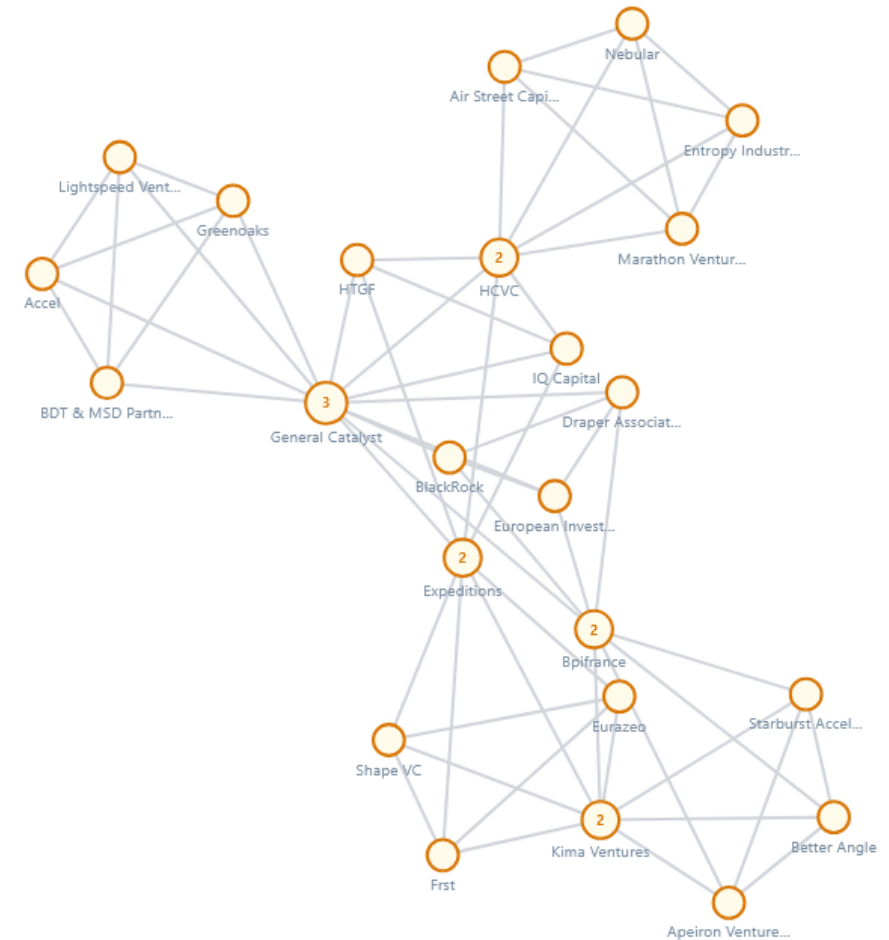
a) We created a test list of companies based on market capitalization or economic valuation (for unlisted companies, such as startups). Additionally, we asked several Italian and international organizations to suggest names of companies they considered interesting for inclusion in the list.

The list is actually composed by:

- 18 European start-up companies
- 22 Global Tech companies
- 65 Global Defence companies
- 67 Global Mining companies

b) Enrichment of the list of companies with all the subjects (companies, universities, research centers) that received European funds (ex. EDF, Horizon, etc...)

Connect -> [EU Call Checker](#)



4. The research

2.

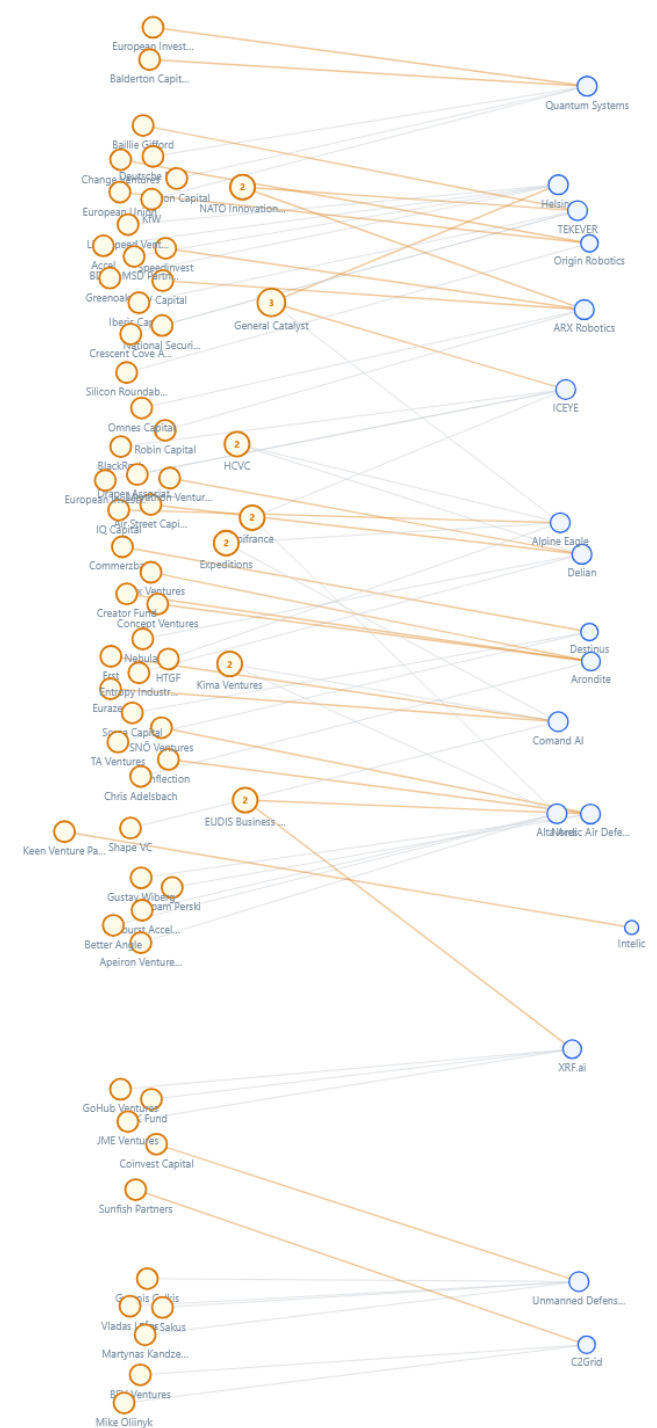
Data collection

a) In mid-February, we opened a one-month paid subscription on Crunchbase, one of the most well-known private databases for information on companies and investment funds. This subscription allowed us to upload our list of companies, view detailed information on them, and export the relevant data for our work in CSV format.

** Unfortunately, a direct API connection is not possible, as the cost exceeds 35,000 USD per year.*

b) Datapitch developed a script to create a GitHub-hosted mini-site for info.nodes. The site lists every company previously identified and includes dedicated pages that organize their Wikipedia data according to a custom schema we designed.

Connect -> [Wikidata Inspector](#)



4. The research

3.

Data analysis

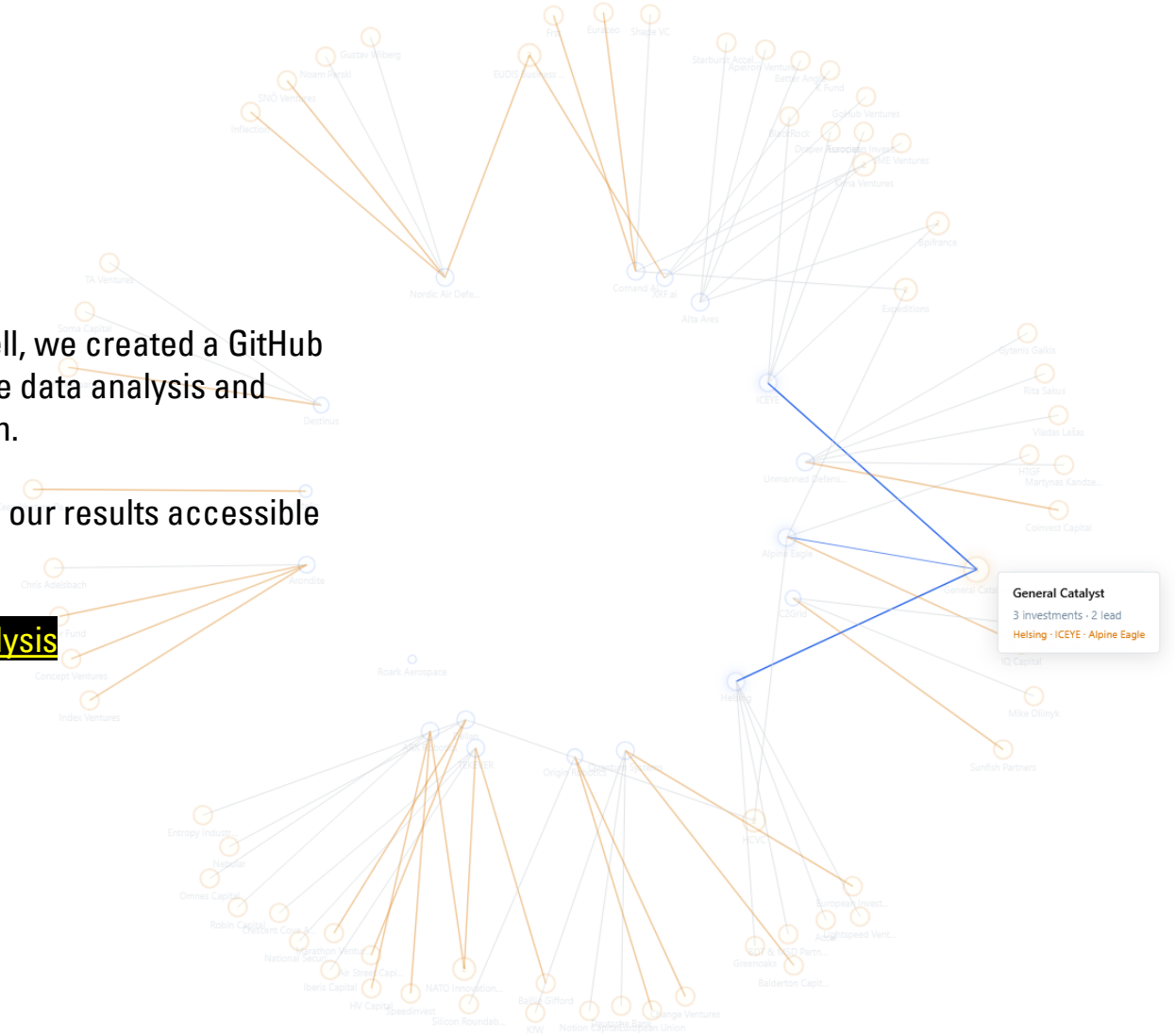
a) Together with Datapitch, we developed a code (using Claude) to analyze the collected data and create network analysis visualizations.

Our core question is: 'Who is investing money in multiple companies and across multiple interconnected sectors?'

b) In this case as well, we created a GitHub repository to host the data analysis and network visualization.

We want to make all our results accessible and free for all.

Connect > Data Analysis



4. The research

4.

Research / Investigation

a) The research team (Davide, Laura, Andrea Daniele) will analyse and investigate the most interest information and publish a report focuses on the European start-up ecosystems, the main private investors in the MoT sector and the stream of EU funds.

Possibility to investigate governance connections and relationships with public universities too.

a) Proposal for a follow up:

Hackaton with P.I. using the data collected by info.nodes and DataPitch.